

SIRI

At an apple conference on October 4 a new assistant program called SIRI was launched, which claims to forever change the way we interact with our phones.

Salvage Bot

NASA is thinking of sending robots into space so as to salvage parts from the "graveyard" belt, an orbit where satellites go to die.

Sony Ericsson Xperia Mini

Updated to sheer brilliance

The updated Xperia Mini is slightly bigger than its predecessor. While the older one had a 2.55-inch display, the new one has a 3-inch one. The keys have been redesigned as well.

The 1GHz processor is paired with 512 MB of RAM. It doesn't get bogged down when you install apps on it, and only slightly slower when you have a bunch of apps running in the background.

The Timescape UI has come a long way since we first saw it. The latest version on the Xperia Mini of Corner UI has app shortcuts on all four edges. Now you can set up to four icons in any of the four clusters. Very convenient and actually useful.

The 3-inch display is LED backlit with a resolution of 320x480 pixels. While this is a slight bump up, size-wise, from its predecessor, it still keeps the Mini well within the tiny smartphone category. However, typing out an SMS just became a lot more comfortable on this.

Camera performance is a bit of a disappointment though. Images are not very crisp, and lack detailing.

Battery lasts 1.5 days with usage including a few voice calls, constant connectivity to either



Wi-Fi or EDGE and the inevitable WhatsApp chats.

The updated Sony Ericsson Xperia Mini is possibly one of the best Android smartphones to have arrived in the market in 2011.

Just goes on to show how important updates are.

A powerful processor, the latest version of Android and premium finish at a box price of ₹13,380 makes this an amazing deal. Otherwise, why not go for the Xperia Mini Pro and get a physical QWERTY keypad as well?

Visbal Mathur

Specifications

Platform: Android 2.3;

Processor: Qualcomm

Snapdragon single core 1GHz, 512MB RAM; **Display:** 3.0-inch

LED display, 320x480 pixel

resolution; **Storage:** 320MB,

microSD slot; **Camera:** 5MP

with 720p videos; **Battery:**

1200 mAh

Contact

Sony Ericsson India

Web site: www.sonyericsson.com

Contact: (124) 4625055

Price: ₹13,380

7.5
10

Features	7.5
Performance.....	7.0
Build Quality	7.5
Value for Money	7.5

Vodafone 555 Blue

Facebook will never be too far away

Specifications

Platform: Proprietary;

Processor: 200MHz; **Display:**

2.4-inch QVGA, 320x240

pixel resolution; **Camera:**

2MP with LED flash; **Storage:**

microSD slot up to 16GB;

Battery: 1000 mAh

Contact

Vodafone India

Web site: www.vodafone.in

Price: ₹4,950

7.0
10

Features	6.5
Performance.....	7.0
Build Quality	7.0
Value for Money	7.0

Facebook integration seems to be the name of the game. We reviewed the HTC ChaCha some time back (<http://goo.gl/4Cj8r>), and that was the first indication of how deeply Facebook can be integrated with the smartphone.

Blue doesn't have the ChaCha's banana curve design, and the keypad layout is also a lot different from the HTC phone. The QWERTY keypad is distinctly divided into four rows, while all keys in one row don't have a lot of spacing between them.

One word- Facebook! The darned Facebook button holds more aces up its sleeve! This time offering functionality and access we had expected, and not remain just a quick post thing.

The 2.4-inch QVGA display has a resolution of 320x240 pixels. It is a pretty okay display for reading text on, and the high-ish brightness levels means that viewing in sunlight won't be a real problem.

Don't expect much from the 2MP camera, except a quick snap to post on Facebook.

Vodafone Blue does cut down on features like Wi-Fi connectivity and 3G. The slow speeds on EDGE means YouTube is almost certainly out of the question.

Despite being a pretty small battery, just 1000 mAh worth of juice, it manages to hold up



quit well - about a day and a half to two days.

The Vodafone 555 Blue is aimed at a very specific audience - the 'social networking

addicted' kids! This

surely isn't a smartphone, but does three things very well - calls, messages and Facebook. Basic looks and build quality, and the phone's hardware specs aren't anything exciting.

For ₹4950, the Vodafone 555 Blue might just be what you need to access Facebook on the cheap.

Visbal Mathur